

Parishes of Glendermott & Strathfoyle

Sunday 30th August 2026

Twenty-second Sunday in Ordinary Time

Are your ways God's ways?

In a major shift from last week, Peter learns how difficult it can be to accept God's way. The previous few lines on St. Matthew's Gospel show Peter recognising Jesus as the Christ, while now he cannot bear to hear that the Lord must suffer, die, and rise again. To us as modern-day listeners, Jesus' reply is abrupt: Peter is thinking "not as God does, but as human beings do." It is a reminder that faith is not simply agreeing with pleasant truths; it is learning to trust God even when the road ahead includes sacrifice. Even Peter took time to realise this.

Jeremiah understands this struggle. God's word burns within him like fire, yet speaking it brings mockery and rejection and many of us know something of that tension. We want to follow Christ, but understandably we also want comfort, approval, and an easier path. We may be tempted to keep quiet, avoid difficult choices, or shape our lives around what the world expects.

Paul's letter to the Romans offers us a practical answer: "Do not conform yourselves to this age but be transformed by the renewal of your mind." Christian discipleship begins in the daily offering of ourselves to God: our time, work, relationships, worries, and hopes. This is not dramatic for most of us. It is found in forgiving someone, serving without being noticed, choosing honesty, praying when tired, or standing beside someone in our lives who is struggling.

Jesus does not ask us to take up the cross because suffering is good in itself. He asks it because love is costly, and true life is found when we give ourselves away as anyone who is married could testify. This week, let us ask for the courage to see with God's eyes and to follow Christ in one concrete choice. The cross we carry with him is never the end of the story; it is the path that leads to resurrection and life.

Baptisms We welcome members of God's family in Baptism, **Broía Ferry-Buchanan**, Old Fort, **Aidah Teresa Elizabeth Callan**, Old Fort and **Darragh Adrian Devlin**, Summer Meadows

Anniversaries – We are asked to remember in prayer: Ann Frazer, Joan Walker, Norman Walker, Rose Henry, Joseph Sebastian, Reuven Simon, Patrick McGrath, Molly Moran, Bridget Killen, Teresa McAtamney, James O'Connell, Angela Hampsey, Eileen Quinn, Harry McClay and Maureen O'Neill

Vocations – That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people. For those interested or even wish to enquire about a call to diocesan priesthood, please contact Fr. Pat O'Hagan, Vocations Director for the Diocese of Derry at pgoh2111@gmail.com

Vocations Society of St Joseph (Waterside Parish) We continue to pray for priests, vocations to priesthood and religious life and support seminarians. The Rosary on Thursday mornings at 9.30am offered for this intention and everyone welcome.

Lectio Divina – Join us on **Thursday** evenings at 8:00pm in St Columb's Church for our weekly praying of the Sacred Scriptures.

Centring Prayer Group – Join us on **Wednesday** at 8:00pm in the St Columb's Church (Parish Hall)

Offertory Collections: Glendermott: £4,150.00 Strathfoyle: £490.00

Thank you for your generosity to the parish collections.

Are you interested in volunteering to help children and adults in our parish to prepare to receive the Sacraments? If you have a basic knowledge of Catholic teaching and some teaching experience (not essential), please contact the Parish Office Tel. 02871 342303. You will join a small parish team and be supported in preparing and delivering sessions. The time commitment would be around 2 hours per week from end of September to May. Safeguarding checks will be carried out.

Waterside Half Marathon takes place on Sunday 6 September and there will be various lane restrictions on Limavady Road, Duke Street, Clooney Road and Temple Road from approximately 7.30am until 1.00pm

“He who sings, prays twice.” (St Augustine) – St Columb’s Church will resume next weekend. We are constantly looking for new singers, maybe you would consider joining, just come along and give it a try or talk to Markus or any choir members.

Season of Creation 2026: The Season of Creation takes place from 1 September to 4 October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year’s theme, Living Water, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God’s creation.

Accord Derry - Marriage Preparation Workshops - September and November 2026. Sept. 25th/26th 2026 – Nov. 20th/21st 2026. These courses are now online for booking at www.accordni.com **Please note** that Accord Derry will **NOT** be facilitating courses during October or December 2026.

Padre Pio Prayer Group, Holy Family Chapel, Ballymagroarty will take place on Tuesday 1 September 2026. Starting with Rosary at 6.45pm before Mass, celebration of holy mass at 7.15pm, then the priest will bless everyone with a first-class relic of St. Pio, while closing prayers are recited.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus’ Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned’s Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI.

Michael English Concert An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2 October at 7.15pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available to buy at online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>

Encounter School of Ministry Course but aren’t sure what it’s about or if it’s for you? Class will take place on Thursdays from 6.30 to 9.00pm beginning on 3rd September at All Saints Church, Newtowncunningham, Co. Donegal. More info or register here: <https://encounterschool.org/donegal/> or email donegal@encounterschool.org for more information.

Job Opportunity: Derry Diocesan Trust - Granaghan (Swatragh)
Parish: Sacristan, hours of work: 12 hours per week. Place of work: St John the Baptist Church. Rate of Pay : £12.88 per hour. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or telephone 028 7126 2302.

Mass & Confession Times

Sunday

St Columb's Church	10.00am, 12.30pm & 6.00pm
Church of Immaculate Conception	10.15am & 12.15pm
St Oliver Plunkett Church	11.15am
St Mary's Oratory	9.15am

Monday – Friday

St Columb's Church	10.00am & 7.30pm
Church of Immaculate Conception	9.15am (Monday – Friday)
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	11.00am (Mon, Tue and Thursday)

St Mary's Oratory	11.00am (Wednesday only)
-------------------	--------------------------

Saturday

St Columb's Church	10.00am & 7.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)
Church of Immaculate Conception	6.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	6.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)

Confessions

St Columb's Church	Monday – Friday 7.00pm – 7.25pm Saturday after 10.00 Mass
Church of Immaculate Conception	Saturday 5.30pm – 5.55pm
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	Saturday 5.30pm – 5.55pm

Parish Office 32 Chapel Road, Derry BT47 2BB. Tel. 02871 342303

Email: secretary@watersideparish.net **Web:** www.watersideparish.net

YouTube Channel: www.youtube.com/WatersideParish

Rev. Michael Canny PP 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

Rev. Patrick Lagan CC 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

Rev Joshy Parokkaran CC 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

SAFEGUARDING CHILDREN AND VULNERABLE ADULTS – If you are concerned about the welfare and safety of children or a vulnerable adult contact: Designated Diocesan Person Ms Marie Gormley at 07596500793 or marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org or PSNI 101.

Our Churches are monitored by CCTV cameras and by live streaming. Live streaming can be viewed online at the parish website. The Diocese of Derry Privacy Notice is displayed on the parish website and Church notice board.
